

Email SMTP Setup Guide

This guide explains how to configure email functionality for the **ABC Website** using **SMTP** and **Nodemailer**, both for local development and production deployment.

Step-by-Step Setup — Local Development

Step 1: Create Your `.env` File

In the project root directory (`ABC-Website`), create a `.env` file from the provided example file.

PowerShell

```
Copy-Item .env.example .env
```

Or Manually

1. Locate `.env.example` in the project root.
2. Duplicate the file.
3. Rename the duplicate to `.env`.

Your project structure should look similar to:

```
ABC-Website/  
├── .env  
├── .env.example  
├── package.json  
└── ...
```

Step 2: Choose an Email Provider

The project uses **SMTP** through **Nodemailer** to send emails.

You can use any SMTP-supported email provider. **Gmail is recommended for local development** because it is easy to configure with an App Password.

Supported examples include:

- Gmail
- Outlook / Microsoft 365
- Yahoo

- Zoho
- Custom-domain email providers

Step 3: Set Up a Gmail App Password

If you are using Gmail, it is recommended to use a **Google App Password** instead of your regular Gmail password.

Important: Your regular Gmail password will not work for SMTP authentication when using this setup. Use an App Password.

1. Open Google Account Security

Go to:

<https://myaccount.google.com/security>

2. Enable 2-Step Verification

2-Step Verification must be enabled before you can create an App Password.

3. Open App Passwords

Go to:

Google Account → Security → App Passwords

4. Create a New App Password

Choose:

- **App:** Mail
- **Device:** Other
- **Name:** ABC Website

5. Copy the Generated Password

Google will generate a **16-character App Password**, for example:

abcd efgh ijkl mnop

Copy the password and remove the spaces before putting it into your `.env` file:

abcdefghijklmnop

This value will be used as `SMTP_PASS`.

Step 4: Configure the .env File

Open the .env file in the project root and add your SMTP configuration.

Gmail Configuration

```
SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com

SMTP_PORT=587

SMTP_USER=your_gmail_address@gmail.com

SMTP_PASS=your16characterapppassword

COMPANY_EMAIL=info@afnamtech.com
```

Example

```
SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com

SMTP_PORT=587

SMTP_USER=krish@gmail.com

SMTP_PASS=abcdefghijklmnop

COMPANY_EMAIL=info@afnamtech.pvt.lmt.in
```

Environment Variables Explained

Variable	Description
SMTP_HOST	SMTP server address. For Gmail, use smtp.gmail.com.
SMTP_PORT	SMTP port. For Gmail with TLS, use 587.
SMTP_USER	Email account that sends the emails.
SMTP_PASS	App Password for the SMTP account.
COMPANY_EMAIL	Email address where enquiries and job applications are delivered.

Can COMPANY_EMAIL and SMTP_USER Be Different?

Yes.

For example:

```
SMTP_USER=yourgmail@gmail.com

COMPANY_EMAIL=info@yourcompany.com
```

In this case:

- `SMTP_USER` is the account used to **send** emails.
- `COMPANY_EMAIL` is the company inbox that **receives** enquiries and applications.

They can also be the same email address.

Step 5: Restart the Server

Environment variables are loaded when the application starts.

Therefore, after modifying `.env`, you must restart the development server.

Stop the Existing Server

Press:

`Ctrl + C`

Start the Server Again

`npm start`

Step 6: Test the Contact Form

After restarting the server:

1. Open the Website

Go to:

`http://localhost:3000`

2. Open the Contact Form

Click:

Get in touch

3. Submit the Form

Enter valid information and submit the form.

4. Check the Confirmation Message

You should see a message similar to:

"Your message has been received..."

5. Check Your Email

You should receive:

Company inbox (COMPANY_EMAIL)

A notification containing the submitted enquiry.

User's email address

A confirmation email sent to the email address entered in the contact form.

If You Are Not Using Gmail

The SMTP settings depend on the email provider you are using.

Outlook / Microsoft 365

Example configuration:

SMTP_HOST=smtp.office365.com

SMTP_PORT=587

SMTP_USER=your_email@outlook.com

SMTP_PASS=your_password_or_app_password

COMPANY_EMAIL=your_company@example.com

Depending on your Microsoft account and organization settings, SMTP authentication may require additional configuration.

Yahoo Mail

Example configuration:

SMTP_HOST=smtp.mail.yahoo.com

SMTP_PORT=587

SMTP_USER=your_email@yahoo.com

```
SMTP_PASS=your_yahoo_app_password
```

```
COMPANY_EMAIL=your_company@example.com
```

Yahoo generally requires an **App Password** for third-party SMTP applications.

Custom Domain — GoDaddy, Zoho, etc.

If you are using a custom-domain email service, use the SMTP settings provided by your email provider.

A typical configuration may look like:

```
SMTP_HOST=mail.yourdomain.com
```

```
SMTP_PORT=587
```

```
SMTP_USER=info@yourdomain.com
```

```
SMTP_PASS=your_email_password
```

```
COMPANY_EMAIL=info@yourdomain.com
```

The SMTP hostname, port, and authentication method can vary between providers. Always check your provider's official SMTP documentation.

Production Setup — Netlify / Vercel

If the website is deployed to a hosting platform, creating a `.env` file on your local computer is **not enough**.

The environment variables must also be configured in your hosting provider's dashboard.

Netlify

Step 1: Open Your Site Dashboard

Go to your Netlify site dashboard.

Step 2: Open Environment Variables

Navigate to:

Site configuration → Environment variables

Step 3: Add the Required Variables

Add:

SMTP_HOST

SMTP_PORT

SMTP_USER

SMTP_PASS

COMPANY_EMAIL

For example:

SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com

SMTP_PORT=587

SMTP_USER=your_gmail@gmail.com

SMTP_PASS=your_app_password

COMPANY_EMAIL=info@yourcompany.com

Step 4: Redeploy the Website

After adding or changing environment variables, redeploy the site so the updated configuration is available to the application.

Vercel

Step 1: Open Your Project

Open your project in the Vercel dashboard.

Step 2: Open Environment Variables

Navigate to:

Project Settings → Environment Variables

Step 3: Add the Required Variables

Add:

SMTP_HOST

```
SMTP_PORT  
  
SMTP_USER  
  
SMTP_PASS  
  
COMPANY_EMAIL
```

Step 4: Redeploy

Redeploy the project after adding or modifying the environment variables.

Security Reminders

Follow these security practices when configuring SMTP.

1. Never Commit `.env` to Git

Do not upload your `.env` file to GitHub or any public repository.

The `.env` file should already be included in `.gitignore`.

For example:

```
.env
```

2. Never Expose SMTP Credentials in Frontend Code

Do **not** put the following values in frontend JavaScript:

```
SMTP_USER  
  
SMTP_PASS
```

SMTP credentials must remain on the server side.

3. Use an App Password

When supported by your email provider, use an **App Password** instead of your primary email account password.

4. Do Not Share Your `.env` File

Your `.env` file contains sensitive credentials. Do not send it to others or upload it publicly.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Possible Fix
Still says "not configured"	Restart the server after editing <code>.env</code> .
"Could not send your message"	Check the SMTP host, port, username, and App Password.
Gmail blocks the login	Make sure you are using a Gmail App Password rather than your regular Gmail password.
2-Step Verification is not enabled	Enable 2-Step Verification before creating a Gmail App Password.
Emails go to spam	Check the recipient's Spam/Junk folder. This can happen with new or unfamiliar senders.
Works locally but not on the live website	Add the required environment variables to your Netlify/Vercel project and redeploy.
Environment variables are not being detected	Verify the variable names exactly match the names expected by the application and restart/redeploy the server.

Quick Configuration Checklist

Before testing the email functionality, make sure:

- `.env` file has been created.
- SMTP provider has been selected.
- Gmail 2-Step Verification is enabled if using Gmail.
- Gmail App Password has been created if required.
- `SMTP_HOST` is correct.
- `SMTP_PORT` is correct.
- `SMTP_USER` is correct.
- `SMTP_PASS` contains the correct App Password.
- `COMPANY_EMAIL` is correct.
- `.env` is included in `.gitignore`.
- The development server has been restarted.
- The contact form has been tested.
- The company inbox has been checked.
- The user's confirmation email has been checked.
- Production environment variables have been added if the site is deployed.

Complete Gmail `.env` Example

```
SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com
```

SMTP_PORT=587

SMTP_USER=your_gmail@gmail.com

SMTP_PASS=abcdefghijklmnop

COMPANY_EMAIL=info@yourcompany.com

Important: Replace the example values with your actual configuration. Never publish or share your real SMTP password or App Password.